

The evening at a glance

Premise

Tulsa's The Meridian Museum of Art & World Cultures is unveiling Treasures of the World, a lavish exhibition drawn largely from the private collection of controversial billionaire donor Sterling Voss. The centerpiece is the fictional thirteenth-century Isfahan Star Bowl, a silver-inlaid brass basin whose incomplete provenance has already attracted quiet controversy. Sterling remains offstage during Act I. Just as guests finish exploring the exhibition and begin dinner, he is found dead in the Donor Salon. He has been poisoned. One of the guests did it - but that guest only learns their role when the murderer animal is announced.

How the game works

- 15 core roles, 10 secondary roles, 5 tertiary roles; tier labels are never shown to players.
- 2.5 hours of active game inside a roughly 6:00-9:30 PM evening with buffet dinner.
- Act I is movement-heavy; Acts II-III prioritize roleplay and social deduction.
- No phones or QR codes. All mechanics are physical.
- Almost no mandatory read-aloud until the final confessions.
- Medium deduction difficulty: the killer should be discoverable but not obvious.
- The facilitator may play a full character and does not know who the murderer is.

Run of show

6:00-6:20	Arrival, animal draw, character mingling
6:20-6:55	Act I free-for-all scavenger hunt through the museum
6:55-7:05	Buffet plates / move to long table
7:05	Announce Sterling Voss is dead; reveal murderer animal
7:10-7:55	Act II investigation and roleplay
7:55	Release fixed forensic evidence + character evidence slips
8:00-8:35	Act III final investigation
8:35-8:45	Ballots: murderer + evidence + motive; best actor; best costume
8:45-9:05	Top three accused final statements; murderer reveal if necessary
9:05-9:30	Awards, dessert, debrief

Player truth rules

- Innocent players may evade, omit, deflect, and protect private information, but may not invent false factual events.
- The murderer may lie as needed.
- If a card explicitly instructs a player to reveal or submit evidence, they must do so.
- Players may share discoveries from Act I freely. Encourage conversation rather than hoarding.

The host-blind animal draw

Prepare two identical sets of 15 easy animal names. Core players draw from Player Bowl A as they arrive and memorize their animal. After all core attendees have drawn, look at the unused slips left in Bowl A and remove those same animals from Murderer Bowl B. Shuffle Bowl B and draw one card. You now know the murderer animal but still do not know who drew it. After Sterling's death is announced, say: "If your animal is __, follow the MURDERER column in your packet. Everyone else follows INNOCENT." Optional-role guests can draw from a separate set of non-murderer animals if you want everyone to participate in the ritual.

Murder announcement / Read aloud

"Before Sterling Voss could enter Founders Hall for his remarks, he was found collapsed in the Donor Salon. The museum's physician has confirmed that this was not a natural death. Sterling Voss was poisoned. From this point on, the gala is an investigation. If your animal is [MURDERER ANIMAL], follow the MURDERER instructions in your packet. Everyone else follows INNOCENT. Do not announce which column you are reading."

Release the fixed evidence

The separate clue/forensics print pack contains five cards labeled F1-F5. Keep them face down until Act III, then place all five on the Evidence Table. You do not need to know their contents in advance.

Turn the house into a museum

Dining Room / Long Table	Founders Hall - main gala floor, ballots, evidence table, dinner seating
Living Room	Grand Gallery - centerpiece display and contemporary works
Kitchen / Island	Sculpture Court - buffet and hospitality zone
Laundry Room	Conservation Lab - condition reports and one scavenger clue
Media Room	Moving Image Gallery / Archives - press and audiovisual materials
Guest Bedroom	Silk Road Gallery - world cultures display
Bathroom	Powder Room / Patron Lounge - one discreet clue, no essential evidence
Dalmo's Office	Donor Salon - fictional murder scene; guests may enter only during Act I scavenger hunt
Viv's Office	Registrar & Provenance Office - shipping/provenance materials

Act I / Hide discoveries 1–8

Sixteen numbered clues are hidden around the museum. A finder earns one point and brings the clue to the Evidence Table, where it becomes public. No required order or checklist. End the hunt when time is called; missing finds cannot make the murder unsolvable.

1	Dalmo office / Donor Salon	Inside or beneath a folder
2	Viv office / Registrar	Behind a binder or clipboard
3	Bathroom / Patron Lounge	Near the mirror or folded hand towel
4	Media room / Archives	Inside a magazine or program
5	Laundry / Conservation Lab	Beside cleaning or craft supplies
6	Dalmo office / Donor Salon	Under a legal-size envelope
7	Living room / Grand Gallery	Inside an exhibition catalogue
8	Living room / Grand Gallery	Behind a frame or display card

Act I / Hide discoveries 9–16

9	Dining room / Founders Hall	Under an education-program brochure
10	Dalmo office / Donor Salon	Near the room sign or faux security note
11	Media room / Archives	Inside an old-looking notebook
12	Living room / Grand Gallery	Beside an art label or sketch
13	Laundry / Conservation Lab	Under a condition-report clipboard
14	Guest bedroom / Silk Road Gallery	Attached to or inside a prop crate/box
15	Media room / Archives	Near the TV/projector/lighting controls
16	Kitchen / Sculpture Court	Near the buffet/service area

Ballots & the reveal

- Each ballot names one murderer, one piece of evidence, and a motive; plus Best Actor and Best Costume.
- Tally murderer votes first. Announce the three most-accused characters in ascending order.
- Those three read their FINAL STATEMENT from the appropriate Innocent/Murderer branch.
- If the actual murderer is not among the top three, award the murderer an 'Escaped Justice' prize, then ask the murderer animal to identify themselves and read the confession.
- Award scavenger recognition separately so solving the murder is not the only way to win.

Preparation / This week & the day before

This week

- Assign the 15 core roles first; add secondary and tertiary roles as RSVPs grow.
- Send each guest only their spoiler-safe pre-party character sheet plus the invitation.
- Tell guests costumes can be assembled from normal formalwear plus one character-specific element.

Day before

- Print this guide, props, private player packets, and randomized A/B evidence cards.
- Without reading the secret material, place each character's private page plus both A/B evidence cards in a labeled envelope.
- Cut two identical sets of core animal cards for Player Bowl A and Murderer Bowl B.
- Cut ballots and scavenger clues; prepare an Evidence Table and scavenger score sheet.
- Stage inexpensive exhibit objects and placards in the room map.

Print settings

Print single-sided at Actual size (100%). Print private files face down and keep the output tray covered. Follow the separate host-safe assembly guide to cut and seal packets. Each guest receives two private pages plus both A/B evidence cards.

Preparation / Before guests arrive

1–2 hours before arrival

- Hide the sixteen Act I clues. Do not make them extremely difficult; movement and discovery matter more than searching skill.
- Place the fixed forensic cards face down for Act III.
- Put each attending player's private packet at their assigned dining seat or hand it to them at check-in.
- Start with all 15 core animals in both bowls. After the attending core players have drawn from Bowl A, note the unused animal slips still left there, remove those same names from Murderer Bowl B, then draw the murderer animal from Bowl B.
- Set out awards, pens, ballots, and a container for submitted Evidence Update cards.

Check the envelopes

One labeled envelope per attending guest: two private packet pages and both A/B evidence cards. Keep all contents private until the indicated act.

Check the bowls

Two identical sets of core animal slips. Optional animals belong in a separate bowl. Remove each absent core animal from Bowl B before drawing the murderer animal.

Cast assignment / Core

Facilitator logistics only: assign all 15 core roles first. Add secondary roles next, then tertiary roles. Do not show tier labels to guests.

01	Adrian Vellum	Executive Director of the Meridian Museum
02	Celeste Frame	Chief Curator of World Cultures
03	Grant Easel	International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison
04	Margot Ledger	Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum
05	Rafael Gilt	Chief Conservator
06	Imogen Muse	Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity
07	Julian Brush	Celebrated Contemporary Painter
08	Helena Cross	Cultural Property Attorney
09	Dr. Marcus Pryce	Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar
10	Sienna Voss	Philanthropist & Heir to the Voss Family Fortune
11	Everett Locke	Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator
12	Nadia Quill	Investigative Arts Journalist
13	Lucian Gable	Exhibition Architect & Designer
14	Vivienne Marrow	International Cultural Heritage Envoy
15	Theo Glass	Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron

Cast assignment / Optional

Facilitator logistics only: assign all 15 core roles first. Add secondary roles next, then tertiary roles. Do not show tier labels to guests.

16	Beatrice Plinth	Founding Curator Emerita
17	Conrad Gavel	Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House
18	Lola Loom	Textile Artist & Designer
19	Sebastian Reed	Doctoral Fellow in Art History
20	Malcolm Carrara	Sculptor & Public-Art Star
21	Daphne Palette	Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture
22	Morgan Slate	Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster
23	Felix Savoy	Head Caterer & Hospitality Director
24	Calvin Case	Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist
25	Maya Bell	Director of Education & Docent Programs
26	Avery Lens	Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist
27	Juno March	Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer
28	Penny Varnish	Eccentric Private Collector
29	Leo Taggart	Tulsa Arts Columnist & Local Historian
30	Riley Bloom	Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer

Protect your own experience

The secret player packets contain each character's relationship to Sterling, hidden complication, innocent branch, murderer branch, evidence-card instructions, and final statements. To preserve your own experience, print those files without reading them and seal each character's packet. The Facilitator Guide contains everything you need to run the night without knowing which branch anyone activates.